

FAITH-BASED AFFORDABLE HOUSING

Turning Church Land into Homes for Our Community

A plain-language guide for pastors, church leaders, and
community groups in the Houston area

WW Housing Development LLC

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Housing needs in your community

Before choosing a project, look at who in your neighborhood needs a home — and what kind.



Income & prices

What can local families afford to pay each month?



Special needs

Seniors, veterans, people with disabilities, young families



Housing type

Rental or ownership?
Apartments, townhomes, or houses?



Quality & resilience

Aging homes, repairs, and flood and storm safety



Location

Access to jobs, transit, schools, and services



THE OPPORTUNITY

Why churches are well placed to help



You may already own the land

Many Houston churches hold vacant lots or underused buildings.



You have the community's trust

Neighbors know you. That matters for support and approvals.



New money is coming

A recently passed federal housing bill is expected to release new funds.



You need a guide, not a gamble

Financing and city rules are complex. We explain them in plain terms.

Four ways to use your property



New Construction

- Build on empty land
- Budget for roads and utility hook-ups
- Uses today's materials, codes, and design



Rehabilitation

- Fix up an existing housing property
- Utilities and permits often already in place
- Lower cost, but watch for hidden repairs



Redevelopment

- Tear down and build new on the same site
- Account for existing utilities and needed changes



Adaptive Reuse

- Convert a non-housing building into homes
- Example: school, hospital, or church building
- Bigger zoning and interior changes

Who develops affordable housing?



Nonprofits

Churches, CDCs, and community housing groups. Mission first.



Public Sector

Housing authorities. Federal funds and deep experience.



For-Profit Developers

Any size. Use standard financing; may partner with nonprofits.



Joint Ventures

Partners share risk, money, land, and know-how on one deal.

Three phases, three key roles



Predevelopment

- Find the site and secure control
- Build the team: design, construction, property management
- Find and lock in financing

Role: *The Developer*



Construction

- Manage the build through subcontractors
- Oversee the construction budget
- Keep the project on schedule

Role: *The Construction Manager*



Management & Operations

- Lease units and collect rent
- Maintain the property
- Provide or arrange resident services

Role: *The Property Manager*

Ways to finance your project



Housing Tax Credits

LIHTC deals serving families at 60% or 80% of area median income (AMI)



Your Land as Equity

Contribute or owner-finance your land as your share of the deal



City & HUD Programs

City of Houston programs and federal HUD grants



Private Capital

Investor-funded build-to-rent, reviewed case by case against your goals



Land Sale + Upside

Sell the land and keep a share of the project's future value



New Federal Funds

Money expected under the recently passed federal housing bill

Straight talk: deals aimed at 40% AMI often do not bring in enough rent to work. We will tell you up front what is realistic.

With you from first conversation to closing



Option A: Consulting & Navigation

We guide you through every step while a licensed developer builds the project.

Option B: Co-Development Partner

We join the deal as co-developer, so your advocate has a real stake in the outcome.

Legal know-how meets ministry leadership



T. Deon Warner, Esq.

Principal, Warner & Associates PLLC

- Transactional real estate and church property attorney
- Structures tax credit deals, seller-financed closings, and development agreements
- Handles legal structure, tax planning, and closing documents



Dr. Marilyn White

Senior Pastor, St. James UMC, Third Ward

- Led development of a \$33 million affordable senior housing community
- 22 years as a commercial insurance executive underwriter
- 30+ years of corporate, nonprofit, and faith-based leadership

LET'S GET STARTED

Your next step

1

Meet with us

In person in Houston, or by Zoom.

2

Start your engagement

\$2,500 preparation fee covers the initial review, materials, and project scope.

3

Get your roadmap

A clear, plain-language plan for your property.



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